

Monopoly Speed

The traditional version of Monopoly is designed for long playtimes and has its own quirks. Each game can go on for hours at a time, only four people can play at a time unless someone really likes to be a banker, and it can stop being fun towards the end of the game. Monopoly Speed addresses a number of these problems at once, with each game lasting only eight minutes. The setup takes about two additional minutes, which brings the total game time to ten minutes. All the property cards are laid out next to their properties around the game board. The bank is placed in the middle, and there is no banker. Three Chance and Community Chest cards are dealt out to everyone. In the box is a timer that indicates the time remaining for each round, and the current phase of the game. There are two phases, the regular one and trading. There is a timer, which initiates the game. All four players have to move at once, throwing the dice, moving their

tokens, and picking up the properties. All the properties cost one note, and these are just thrown into the bank. There are no rents or hotels. During the trading phase, players can use their Chance and Community Chest cards, hold on to them, or exchange properties and Cash. There are two Go squares around the board, so you pick up a salary twice every circuit. There is a Go to Jail corner, but the superintendent is AWOL so you can just walk out of prison any time. Even the tokens are representative of the frenzied pace of the game, with a kitty on skates, a doggo on a skateboard, a racing car and a speedboat. This is a fast game full of bedlam. The timer can be paused to settle disputes, but really breaks the pacing of the game if it is ever used. The box itself is oddly angled, which is an eye catching and interesting design no doubt, but which

might be difficult to smoothly stack with your other titles. In Speed, Monopoly is stripped to its most essential components, with players having to take turns in a continuous frenzied stream, with breaks for trading and actions



that are wild and chaotic. While the version is definitely fun, the energy levels required are not sustainable. Once a few games are done, it is only natural to return to the more relaxed, yet strategic Monopoly Deal.

PRICE: ₹1,999

Inbase Urban Fit and Beep

Inbase, a digital product company that deals largely with phone accessories have come up with two new smartwatches for the Indian market. The Inbase Urban Fit and Urban Beep.

As is the norm with most smartwatches today, they have the usual health tracking features you'd come to expect, such as a step counter, heart rate sensor, sleep timer, calories calculator, and even sPO2, or oxygen saturation measure. These features are present on both the Fit and Beep versions of the smartwatch. Additionally, they're both IPX 68 certified as well, so both shock-proof and water-resistant.

Both models, Fit and Beep, are powered by Bluetooth 4.2 and are compatible with iOS as well as Android devices. The primary differences between the two versions, other than the shape of the watches – the Urban Fit has a square-ish face

while the Urban Beep features a circular face – is the presence of camera and music controls on the Inbase Urban Fit model. Additionally, neither watch has any buttons on it, and interaction is done purely via touch. For the most part touch worked just fine for us, but at times it did feel a bit wonky and delayed.

Inside the box, you have the watch itself, and an additional box. Inside this box is the USB-A charging adapter, the user manual, and the warranty card, which is valid for up to a year from the date of purchase. The Inbase Urban Beep features a standby time of approximately 30 days, which is double the standby time of the Urban Fit, which only has 15 days. The Urban Fit uses a 180 mAh battery, which can take up to 90 minutes to charge fully. The Urban Beep's battery capacity is 150 mAh.

PRICE: ₹4,999 for the Urban Fit, ₹3,999 for the Urban Beep

